

COMMAND LINE CONFIGURATION

You can enhance you Linux experience quite a bit if you don't harbour any hang-ups about entering commands in the terminal window or editing configuration files

Installing True Type fonts

If you like the Windows feel, you must sorely miss the True Type fonts and especially so if you are browsing using Netscape. The sites just don't feel the same. The option? Install your True Type fonts in Linux itself. You can use a utility called Xfree 4.0 that has been around for some time and comes with True Type support. First, create a directory called truetype in /usr/X11R6/lib/X11/fonts/ for the True Type fonts and copy all your .ttf (True Type fonts) files into this directory. Now, from within this directory, run the command `mkttdir`. After this, add the following line to your XF86Config file: `FontPath /usr/X11R6/lib/X11/fonts/truetype` (where truetype is the directory you created). Restart X. Now, your Netscape or for that matter even your word processing software will give you the familiar Windows feel.

Adding or removing font paths from X

You can edit the XF86Config file to add or remove your font paths. And you can do the same even while working in X using the `xset` command. Use the command `xset +fp,fp+,fp- fontpath`. Here the plus sign before `fp` adds the new font path before the current path. The plus sign after `fp` appends the font path. Similarly, the minus sign removes the specified font path. For instance, `xset +fp /usr/X11R6/lib/fonts/truetype` will add the truetype directory fonts before the existing selection.

Shutting down from a desktop environment

Even within the desktop environment, whether KDE or Gnome or anything else, you can use the terminal window or console for shutting down or restarting. Open a terminal emulation window and

type `shutdown -r` or `shutdown -h` to reboot or shutdown your system, respectively. You will have to enter your password in the dialog box that comes first. Remember that this will close all running applications and you will not have the option of saving your work or the session.

Killing an X session

Well, it's quite possible that a KDE or Gnome session might crash, so in such cases you can kill the X session and get the login prompt by using the [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Backspace] keys. Again, make sure you save your work before trying this out.

Copy-paste in terminal window

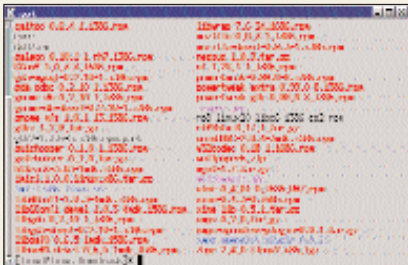
To copy-paste text with the mouse, you need to have `gpm` installed. You can then highlight the text with the mouse, move the cursor to the desired location and use the centre-button to paste the text. And if you don't feel like using the mouse, you can always use the shortcut keys [Shift] + [Insert] to paste the text.

Optimising terminal emulators

Most of us don't really bother about the terminal emulator that we have in our desktop environment. We generally end up using the default `xterm` that is standard with most distributions.

But in case of a slow video card, `rxvt` is a better option since `xterm` contains legacy codes and seems unduly bloated for a simple terminal emulator. `xterm` tends to be bloated because it not only functions as a plain text terminal emulator but also has the capability to emulate graphical modes which are rarely used.

With a graphics card that isn't exactly fast, `xterm` may end up consuming quite some time. So you should switch to `rxvt`. `rxvt` also has some features such

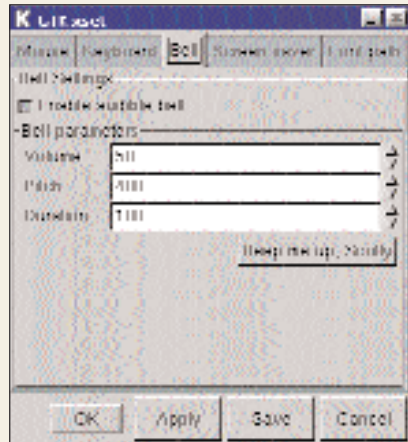


Use the rxvt terminal emulator

as pixmap backgrounds and a better scrollbar. You can use the pixmap option on the command line to any .xpm-format picture in the background and without hogging up the system resources at that.

Sound and mouse configuration

You can disable the terminal bell in X by running the command `xset -b`. You can also specify settings for the bell with this command line. For instance, `xset b 50 500 5` would change the setting of the bell to 50 per cent of the original volume at 500 Hz for 5 milliseconds. A similar tool known as `gxset` is available with a GUI interface and this too allows you to modify mouse acceleration features.



Change bell parameters with gxset

Ad will come